

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments product owner who has shipped the full stack from P2P fintech to POS.*

Positioning, ten years owning regulated payment and fintech products end-to-end, now bringing that depth to CNTXT AI's payments roadmap in Dubai.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY CNTXT AI

The role sits at the intersection of AI and financial infrastructure, two areas I have worked in separately and am now deliberately converging. The posting explicitly names payment gateways, processors, reconciliation, and failure-handling as the day-to-day vocabulary, which is exactly the territory I mapped at Kvitt Payment Solutions and Scheidt & Bachmann. The phrase "reliability, conversion, and operational efficiency" in the description is a precise description of the triangle I optimised at Kvitt before Sparkasse acquired the product. *That is the kind of problem where a decade of scar tissue pays compound interest.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case enumeration
- **GitHub Copilot**, daily coding assist across Python and SQL
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping for payment UX flows
- **Cursor / VSCode**, day-to-day development environment
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes and stakeholder demos
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation and integration pipelines
- **GPT**, requirement drafting and user-story refinement
- **Gamma.app**, structured stakeholder presentations

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Kafka, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitOps, Docker, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Dagster, dbt, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Azure DevOps, Git, GitLab, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Mobile group-based P2P payment app, built from zero and acquired by Sparkasse into the girocard ecosystem.

- Built the full payment flow: split-bill UX, P2P settlement, edge-case handling for partial payments, refunds, and failed transactions.
 - Integrated with the girocard ecosystem and banking partners, navigating regulatory and compliance requirements end to end.
 - Operated solo from incorporation to acquisition; owned product, finance, and stakeholder management throughout.
 - Direct proof of the payment gateway, processor, and settlement mechanics this role requires.
-

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT CNTXT AI

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow existing payment flows end to end, gateway integrations, settlement runs, reconciliation cadence, failure and refund handling, and document where manual workarounds are hiding upstream problems.

WEEK 2

Slice, validate, prioritise.

Turn the gap map into a prioritised backlog, validate the top items against engineering capacity and compliance constraints, and get the first sprint cut by the end of the week.

Ship, measure, close.

Push the first improvement through to production, instrument it with clear KPIs, and open the discovery loop with payment partner contacts and internal finance operations stakeholders.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at CNTXT AI,

I am applying for the Product Manager / Product Owner, Payments role. My interest is direct: I founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P group-payment product that was acquired by Sparkasse and operated inside the girocard ecosystem. I built it from zero, owned the payment gateway integrations, the settlement and reconciliation logic, the refund and failure paths, and the regulatory dialogue with banking partners. That is the core vocabulary of this role, and it is where I have the deepest hands-on scar tissue.

Beyond Kvitt, I have thirteen years of end-to-end product ownership across regulated industries. At Scheidt & Bachmann I owned the integration of POS and forecourt payment systems in a SAFe environment. At EMIL Group I shipped an insurance B2B SaaS Claims Center from concept to production, cutting time-to-market for a new product line from months to under a week. At Rohde & Schwarz I introduced GitOps delivery that took platform rollout from days to thirty minutes, a pattern directly applicable to payment gateway configuration and hotfix deployment. The thread across these roles is the same: I take operational complexity, map it rigorously, and reduce it to something a lean cross-functional team can ship and maintain.

The job description names payment failures, settlement, reconciliation, and operational efficiency as central concerns. These are not abstract concepts to me. At Kvitt I debugged failed transactions at the network layer, rebuilt reconciliation logic when bank statements did not match internal ledgers, and designed the retry and fallback UX that kept the user experience intact when a payment processor was slow. I also handled the compliance and security requirements that come with operating inside a regulated payment ecosystem, a skill I carried into my later roles as Deputy IT Security Officer at Bundesagentur für Arbeit.

I am an AI-native practitioner. I use Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, and Lovable daily, not as productivity theatre but as the actual toolchain through which I generate specs, enumerate edge cases, prototype flows, and accelerate the gap between discovery and engineering handoff. In a fast-moving AI/FinTech environment this matters: I do not wait for a designer or a developer to make a hypothesis testable.

Dubai is a genuine target for me, not a compromise. I am actively seeking to relocate to the UAE and am fully open to on-site work there. I can be available on four weeks' notice. I would welcome a conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with thirteen years of end-to-end ownership in regulated industries, fintech, insurance, defence AI, public-sector analytics, and healthcare. I founded and sold a P2P payment product inside the girocard ecosystem, owned POS and forecourt payment integrations at Scheidt & Bachmann, and have repeatedly taken operationally complex products from discovery through production in cross-functional, compliance-heavy environments. My operating mode is discovery-first, data-informed, and engineering-close.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Payments and FinTech: P2P payment flows, gateway and PSP integration, settlement and reconciliation, refund and failure handling, girocard ecosystem, POS and forecourt systems, banking partner management, compliance and regulatory requirements.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP and PoC definition, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitOps, Docker, Jenkins, CI/CD, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Azure DevOps.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership and financial planning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI / DATA PLATFORM 2024 TO 2025

Introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team: rollout time fell from days to 30 minutes. Redirected product from UI-led to developer-code-first design based on instrumented usage data.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023 TO 2024

Integrated test automation into Jenkins pipeline, introduced Dagster and dbt for quarterly data imports, migrated bare-metal to containers, and delivered a full UI relaunch. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut a three-person team's roadmap to the top 10% of features: user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM hospital interface myself; digital anamnesis dropped from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center concept to production; time-to-market for a new insurance product fell from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · PAYMENTS / POS 2021 TO 2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning. Retail and forecourt payment systems.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · SECURE DATA PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B 2019 TO 2020

Migrated legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · SITE IT MODERNISATION 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end for a wind-energy operator.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK 2017 TO 2018

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025 TO 2026

Two-sided B2B marketplace built zero to one alone. Anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016 TO 2021

Shipped a three-layer enterprise encryption product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRI-NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018 TO 2021

Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013 TO 2018

Built a mobile group P2P payment product from zero; acquired by Sparkasse and operated inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · CNTXT AI

